

Ali Ahmadi

Queen's University, Smith School of Business
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Competitive Dynamics, Behavioral Strategy, Artificial Intelligence, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Management, Strategy

2021- 2027

Queen's University, Smith School of Business, Kingston, Ontario

Dissertation Title: *Competitive Surprise: A research agenda*

Committee: Professors Goce Andrevski, Danny Miller, Anthony Goerzen, Jean-Baptiste Litrico

Proposal defended December 2025

MBA in Strategy

2020

Industrial Management Institute, Tehran, Iran;

BSc in Mechanical Engineering

2017

Babol Noshirvani Institute of Technology, Babol, Iran;

PUBLICATIONS

Goudarzi, K., **Ahmadi, A.**, & Andrevski, G. (2026). From protection to adjustment: How rival repositioning alters competitive action repertoires. *Journal of Business Research* ([Link](#)) (ABDC: A-Journal)

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

Andrevski, G., **Ahmadi, A.**, & Miller, D. Competitive Surprise: A Theoretical Framework. Invited for 2nd round revise and resubmit at the *Academy of Management Review* (FT50 – ABDC: A*)

ADVANCED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Pimentel, E., **Ahmadi, A.**, Bel Hadj Ali, S., Ricci, L. Bodies at Work: A Critical Review and Organizing Framework for a Corporeal Approach to Organization Studies. (*Final Edits*). Submitting to *Journal of Management Studies* in 2026

Ahmadi, A., Andreovski, G., Miller, D., Antecedents and Performance Implications of Surprise Capability: An Empirical Analysis. Submitting to *Academy of Management Journal* in Fall 2026 (*Final Edits*).

Ahmadi, A., Goudarzi, K., How Merger Announcements Shape Investor and Rival Responses: Insights from an AI text analysis.
Target Journal: *Academy of Management Journal*. (*Data analysis*).

Ahmadi, A., Andreovski, G., Miller, D., Competitive Surprise and Rival Response Time: An Event Study. Target Journal: *Academy of Management Journal*. (*Data analysis*)

OTHER PROJECTS

- Competitive Surprise: A Multiple Case-Study with Goce Andreovski (*Ethics accepted, participant recruitment stage*)
- Anticipated departures and team investment: a longitudinal archival study in Formula 1 racing with Kaylee Somerville (*Data collected, analysis stage*)

BOOK CHAPTERS

Ahmadi, A., & Arndt, F. (2022). Dynamic Capabilities and Innovation. in *Innovation*; Routledge.

Salamzadeh, A., **Ahmadi, A.,** & Safar Kamel, A. (2022). The Context for Business in Iraq. Understanding Contexts of Business in *Western Asia: Land of Bazaars and High-Tech Booms*

Toghraee, M. T., **Ahmadi, A.,** & Salamzadeh, A. (2022). Arts entrepreneurs in an emerging economy. In *Artisan and handicraft entrepreneurs: past, present, and future* (pp. 137-147). Springer International Publishing.

Hosseini, E., Tajpour, M., Salamzadeh, A., & **Ahmadi, A.** (2022). Team performance and the development of Iranian digital start-ups: the mediating role of employee voice. In *Managing human resources in SMEs and start-ups: international challenges and solutions*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Queen's University

Fall 2024, 2025

Business and Corporate Strategy - COMM 401

1 Section – Fall 2024 - 85 Students - Evaluation: 6.23/7

1 Section – Fall 2025 – 86 Students - Evaluation: 6.71/7

Developed a novel AI-powered case delivery method on LiveCases.Org

Workshop Instructor, Queen's University

Teaching with AI – Interactive AI-powered Case Studies

- Teaching & Learning in Business PhD course **2025**
- Strategy faculty brownbag **2024**

Python Programming with AI for non-tech commerce students **2025**Data access from web and APIs – University of Saint Andrews, Scotland **2026****Teaching Assistant, Queen's University****2022 - 2025**

COMM401(2022, 2023, 2025, 2026) MBAS832(2022,2023,2024,2025,2026) -

MBAS883(2023, 2026)-MBUS803(2024, 2025, 2026)-COMM306(2023, 2024)

MBQC 800 (2025, 2026) EMBA Queen's/Cornell University(2025, 2026)

AWARDS

D.D. Monieson Doctoral Fellowship (\$5,000)**Feb 2025**

Smith School of Business

PhD Student Research Excellence Award (\$1,500)**April 2025**

Smith School of Business

**Program on Investment Appraisal and Risk Analysis
Scholarship (USD 15,900)****June 2026**

Queen's University Economics Department

Best Paper Award**July 2026**

Competitive Dynamics Conference

University of Virginia, Darden School of Business

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Community Builder and Business Analyst**Aug 2019 - Mar 2021**

Hamboodgah Crowdfunding, Tehran, Iran

Business Analyst**May 2018 - Jan 2019**

Rata Crowdfunding, Tehran, Iran

Business Analyst Intern**Jan 2018 - May 2018**

ILIA International Consulting, Tehran, Iran

NON-PROFIT AND VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Judge**2023-2025**

ICBC, Kingston, Ontario

Founder and Managing Director

Sari Astronomy Club

Non-Profit NGO for public science communication

Dec 2012 - Nov 2017**Licensee and Organizer**

TEDx Sari

the third city-scale TEDx event in Iran

Mar 2016 - Mar 2018**Speechwriter and Curator**

TEDx Amirkabir University (May 2019)

TEDx Esfahan (Dec 2020, Aug 2019)

TEDx HSU (Apr 2018)

TEDx University of Tehran (Jul 2022, Feb 2021)

Apr 2018 – Feb 2021**Languages**

English

IELTS General 8.5/9 – IELTS Academic 8/9

Bilingual – C2**Persian****Native****French****Professional –B2****Turkish****Professional – B1****Azeri****Professional – B1****Arabic****Limited Proficiency – A2**